

Project: Smart 4-Way Traffic Light Controller

1. Introduction

1.1 Background

This project designs, analyses, and simulates a Smart 4-Way Traffic Light Controller that implements the Ethiopian national traffic standard. The Ethiopian standard extends the conventional three-phase sequence (Green → Yellow → Red) by inserting a preparatory Red+Yellow phase before the Green phase, giving drivers a clear visual warning that they are about to be given right-of-way.

1.2 Project Objectives

The specific objectives of this project are:

- Design a synchronous sequential logic circuit that controls traffic lights at a four-way intersection following the Ethiopian Green → Yellow → Red + Yellow → Red sequence.
- Implement the design using only standard 74LS-series digital ICs: JK flip-flops (74LS76), AND gates (74LS08), OR gates (74LS32), NOT gates (74LS04), XOR gates (74LS86), a resettable counter (74LS163), and multiplexers (74LS153).
- Apply the full 7-step synchronous counter design methodology: state diagram, next-state table, flip-flop transition table, circuit excitation table, Karnaugh maps, logic expressions, and hardware implementation.
- Verify the design through simulation in Proteus 8 Professional.

2. Synchronous Counter Design — 7-Step Methodology

This section applies the 7-step synchronous counter design methodology (as taught in ECEG 3161) to the Smart 4-Way Traffic Light Controller. The full FSM is modelled as a 16-state MOD-16 binary counter using JK flip-flops. Steps 1–6 are covered in full; Step 7 (hardware wiring) is summarised in Section 5.

STEP 1 — State Diagram

State Assignment & Encoding

Sixteen states are required: 4 ways × 4 phases each. The states are encoded as a 4-bit binary value (Q3 Q2 Q1 Q0) where Q3,Q2 identify the active way and Q1,Q0 identify the phase within that way. This encoding results in a natural binary count sequence (0000 → 0001 → ... → 1111 → 0000) — a MOD-16 synchronous binary counter.

State	Q3	Q2	Q1	Q0	Active Way	Phase	RED	YEL	GRN
0	0	0	0	0	Way A	GREEN	0	0	1
1	0	0	0	1	Way A	YELLOW	0	1	0
2	0	0	1	0	Way A	RED+YEL	1	1	0
3	0	0	1	1	Way A	RED (Wait)	1	0	0
4	0	1	0	0	Way B	GREEN	0	0	1
5	0	1	0	1	Way B	YELLOW	0	1	0
6	0	1	1	0	Way B	RED+YEL	1	1	0
7	0	1	1	1	Way B	RED (Wait)	1	0	0
8	1	0	0	0	Way C	GREEN	0	0	1
9	1	0	0	1	Way C	YELLOW	0	1	0
10	1	0	1	0	Way C	RED+YEL	1	1	0
11	1	0	1	1	Way C	RED (Wait)	1	0	0
12	1	1	0	0	Way D	GREEN	0	0	1
13	1	1	0	1	Way D	YELLOW	0	1	0
14	1	1	1	0	Way D	RED+YEL	1	1	0
15	1	1	1	1	Way D	RED (Wait)	1	0	0

Circular State Transition

The state transition diagram forms a single closed loop. Every transition is gated by **TIMER_DONE (T)**: when T=0 the FSM holds the current state; when T=1 it advances on the next rising clock edge.

**S0 → S1 → S2 → S3 → S4 → S5 → S6 → S7
→ S8 → S9 → S10 → S11 → S12 → S13 → S14 → S15 → S0**

Way Group	States	Binary Range	Phase Sequence
Way A	S0 → S1 → S2 → S3	0000 → 0011	GREEN → YELLOW → RED+YEL → RED
Way B	S4 → S5 → S6 → S7	0100 → 0111	GREEN → YELLOW → RED+YEL → RED
Way C	S8 → S9 → S10 → S11	1000 → 1011	GREEN → YELLOW → RED+YEL → RED
Way D	S12 → S13 → S14 → S15	1100 → 1111	GREEN → YELLOW → RED+YEL → RED

STEP 2 — Next-State Table

The next-state table lists every present state (Q3 Q2 Q1 Q0), the active way, the current phase, and the next state (Q3+ Q2+ Q1+ Q0+). Because this is a MOD-16 binary counter, the next state is always (present + 1) mod 16.

Present State	Q3	Q2	Q1	Q0	Way	Present Phase	Q3+	Q2+	Q1+	Q0+	Next State	Next Phase
0	0	0	0	0	A	GREEN	0	0	0	1	1	YELLOW
1	0	0	0	1	A	YELLOW	0	0	1	0	2	RED+YEL
2	0	0	1	0	A	RED+YEL	0	0	1	1	3	RED (Wait)
3	0	0	1	1	A	RED (Wait)	0	1	0	0	4	GREEN
4	0	1	0	0	B	GREEN	0	1	0	1	5	YELLOW
5	0	1	0	1	B	YELLOW	0	1	1	0	6	RED+YEL
6	0	1	1	0	B	RED+YEL	0	1	1	1	7	RED (Wait)
7	0	1	1	1	B	RED (Wait)	1	0	0	0	8	GREEN
8	1	0	0	0	C	GREEN	1	0	0	1	9	YELLOW
9	1	0	0	1	C	YELLOW	1	0	1	0	10	RED+YEL
10	1	0	1	0	C	RED+YEL	1	0	1	1	11	RED (Wait)
11	1	0	1	1	C	RED (Wait)	1	1	0	0	12	GREEN
12	1	1	0	0	D	GREEN	1	1	0	1	13	YELLOW
13	1	1	0	1	D	YELLOW	1	1	1	0	14	RED+YEL
14	1	1	1	0	D	RED+YEL	1	1	1	1	15	RED (Wait)
15	1	1	1	1	D	RED (Wait)	0	0	0	0	0	GREEN

STEP 3 — Flip-Flop Transition Table

JK Flip-Flop Excitation Rules

The excitation table specifies the J and K input values required to produce each possible $Q \rightarrow Q+$ transition in a JK flip-flop:

Present Q	Next Q+	Required J	Required K	Explanation
0	0	0	X	Hold LOW – J=0 prevents set; K irrelevant
0	1	1	X	Set – J=1 forces output HIGH; K irrelevant
1	0	X	1	Reset – K=1 forces output LOW; J irrelevant
1	1	X	0	Hold HIGH – K=0 prevents reset; J irrelevant

Complete Transition Table (16 States × 4 Flip-Flops)

Applying the excitation rules to every row of the next-state table produces the required J and K values for each flip-flop at every state:

State	Q3	Q2	Q1	Q0	Q3+	Q2+	Q1+	Q0+	JD	KD	JC	KC	JB	KB	JA	KA
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	X	0	X	0	X	1	X
1	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	X	0	X	1	X	X	1
2	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	1	0	X	0	X	X	0	1	X
3	0	0	1	1	0	1	0	0	0	X	1	X	X	1	X	1
4	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	X	X	0	0	X	1	X
5	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	0	X	X	0	1	X	X	1
6	0	1	1	0	0	1	1	1	0	X	X	0	X	0	1	X
7	0	1	1	1	1	0	0	0	1	X	X	1	X	1	X	1
8	1	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	X	0	0	X	0	X	1	X
9	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	0	X	0	0	X	1	X	X	1
10	1	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	X	0	0	X	X	0	1	X
11	1	0	1	1	1	1	0	0	X	0	1	X	X	1	X	1
12	1	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	X	0	X	0	0	X	1	X
13	1	1	0	1	1	1	1	0	X	0	X	0	1	X	X	1
14	1	1	1	0	1	1	1	1	X	0	X	0	X	0	1	X
15	1	1	1	1	0	0	0	0	X	1	X	1	X	1	X	1

STEP 4 — Circuit Excitation Table

The circuit excitation table combines the present state bits (which serve as INPUTS to the combinational next-state logic network) with the required JK flip-flop values (which are the OUTPUTS of that network). This table is used directly to populate the Karnaugh maps in Step 5.

X entries are don't-care conditions — they arise because JK flip-flops have complementary control: when a bit transitions 0→1 only J matters, and when it transitions 1→0 only K matters. Don't-cares allow larger K-map groupings and simpler expressions.

Minterm (m)	Q3	Q2	Q1	Q0	JD	KD	JC	KC	JB	KB	JA	KA
0	0	0	0	0	0	X	0	X	0	X	1	X
1	0	0	0	1	0	X	0	X	1	X	X	1
2	0	0	1	0	0	X	0	X	X	0	1	X
3	0	0	1	1	0	X	1	X	X	1	X	1
4	0	1	0	0	0	X	X	0	0	X	1	X
5	0	1	0	1	0	X	X	0	1	X	X	1
6	0	1	1	0	0	X	X	0	X	0	1	X
7	0	1	1	1	1	X	X	1	X	1	X	1
8	1	0	0	0	X	0	0	X	0	X	1	X
9	1	0	0	1	X	0	0	X	1	X	X	1
10	1	0	1	0	X	0	0	X	X	0	1	X
11	1	0	1	1	X	0	1	X	X	1	X	1
12	1	1	0	0	X	0	X	0	0	X	1	X
13	1	1	0	1	X	0	X	0	1	X	X	1
14	1	1	1	0	X	0	X	0	X	0	1	X
15	1	1	1	1	X	1	X	1	X	1	X	1

STEP 5 — Karnaugh Maps

Four-variable Karnaugh maps are constructed for each of the 8 JK inputs. Variables Q3, Q2 are on the rows; Q1, Q0 are on the columns. Both axes use Gray-code ordering (00, 01, 11, 10) to guarantee that adjacent cells differ by exactly one variable, enabling valid grouping.

Color coding: Green = 1 (ones cell), Yellow = X (don't-care), White = 0 (zeros cell). Groups of 1s and Xs are circled to form the largest possible power-of-2 groupings.

5.1 FF-D (Q3) — Most Significant Bit

Q3 transitions 0→1 only once (state 7→8) and 1→0 only once (state 15→0). All remaining cells are don't-cares because the flip-flop is not changing state.

K-Map for JD:

Q_3	Q_2	$\backslash Q_1$	Q_0	00	01	11	10
	00			0	0	0	0
	01			0	0	1	0
	11			X	X	X	X
	10			X	X	X	X
Simplified: $J_D = Q_2 \cdot Q_1 \cdot Q_0$							

K-Map for K_D :

Q_3	Q_2	$\backslash Q_1$	Q_0	00	01	11	10
	00			X	X	X	X
	01			X	X	X	X
	11			0	0	1	0
	10			0	0	0	0
Simplified: $K_D = Q_2 \cdot Q_1 \cdot Q_0$							

5.2 FF-C (Q_2)

Q_2 toggles at state 3→4 and 11→12 (0→1) and at state 7→8 and 15→0 (1→0).

K-Map for J_C :

Q_3	Q_2	$\backslash Q_1$	Q_0	00	01	11	10
	00			0	0	1	0
	01			X	X	X	X
	11			X	X	X	X
	10			0	0	1	0
Simplified: $J_C = Q_1 \cdot Q_0$							

K-Map for K_C :

Q_3	Q_2	$\backslash Q_1$	Q_0	00	01	11	10
	00			X	X	X	X
	01			0	0	1	0
	11			0	0	1	0
	10			X	X	X	X
Simplified: $K_C = Q_1 \cdot Q_0$							

5.3 FF-B (Q_1)

Q1 transitions 0→1 at states 1, 5, 9, 13 (where Q0=1, Q1=0) and 1→0 at states 3, 7, 11, 15 (where Q0=1, Q1=1).

K-Map for JB:

Q ₃ Q ₂ \ Q ₁ Q ₀	00	01	11	10
00	0	1	X	X
01	0	1	X	X
11	0	1	X	X
10	0	1	X	X
Simplified: $J_B = Q_0$				

K-Map for KB:

Q ₃ Q ₂ \ Q ₁ Q ₀	00	01	11	10
00	X	X	1	0
01	X	X	1	0
11	X	X	1	0
10	X	X	1	0
Simplified: $K_B = Q_0$				

5.4 FF-A (Q0) — Least Significant Bit

Q0 transitions 0→1 at every even state (0,2,4,...,14) and 1→0 at every odd state (1,3,5,...,15). Every cell is either 1 or X — the entire map is covered.

K-Map for JA:

Q ₃ Q ₂ \ Q ₁ Q ₀	00	01	11	10
00	1	X	X	1
01	1	X	X	1
11	1	X	X	1
10	1	X	X	1
Simplified: $J_A = 1$				

K-Map for KA:

Q ₃ Q ₂ \ Q ₁ Q ₀	00	01	11	10
00	X	1	1	X
01	X	1	1	X
11	X	1	1	X

Q_3	Q_2	$\backslash Q_1$	Q_0	00	01	11	10
	10			X	1	1	X
Simplified: $K_A = 1$							

STEP 6 — Logic Expressions for Flip-Flop Inputs

6.1 Final Minimized JK Flip-Flop Input Equations

The following Boolean expressions are derived directly from the K-map groupings in Step 5. All expressions are ANDed with T (TIMER_DONE) to implement the timer-gated synchronous counting behavior — the counter only advances when the active phase duration has expired.

Flip-Flop	Bit Role	J Input Equation	K Input Equation	Logic Interpretation
FF-A	Q0 (LSB)	$J_A = T$	$K_A = T$	Q0 toggles every tick – no state dependency; connects T directly to J and K
FF-B	Q1	$J_B = Q_0 \cdot T$	$K_B = Q_0 \cdot T$	Q1 toggles when Q0=1 and timer fires; 1× AND gate
FF-C	Q2	$J_C = Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$	$K_C = Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$	Q2 toggles when Q1=Q0=1 and timer fires; 2× chained AND gates
FF-D	Q3 (MSB)	$J_D = Q_2 \cdot Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$	$K_D = Q_2 \cdot Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$	Q3 toggles when Q2=Q1=Q0=1 and timer fires; 3× chained AND gates

6.2 Boolean Expression Summary

$J_A = T$	$K_A = T$
$J_B = Q_0 \cdot T$	$K_B = Q_0 \cdot T$
$J_C = Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$	$K_C = Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$
$J_D = Q_2 \cdot Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$	$K_D = Q_2 \cdot Q_1 \cdot Q_0 \cdot T$

6.3 Output (LED) Logic Equations

The LED outputs are derived purely combinationally from the state bits. Q3,Q2 select which way is active; Q1,Q0 encode the current phase. Every non-active way always displays RED regardless of the current phase.

Phase Signal Definitions (decoded from Q1, Q0):

$RED_phase = Q1$ (HIGH when $Q1=1$: RED+YELLOW and RED states)
 $YEL_phase = Q1 \oplus Q0$ (HIGH when $Q1 \neq Q0$: YELLOW and RED+YELLOW)
 $GRN_phase = Q1' \cdot Q0'$ (HIGH only when $Q1=Q0=0$: GREEN state)

Way-Active Signals (decoded from Q3, Q2):

$WayA = Q3' \cdot Q2'$ (states 0–3)
 $WayB = Q3' \cdot Q2$ (states 4–7)
 $WayC = Q3 \cdot Q2'$ (states 8–11)
 $WayD = Q3 \cdot Q2$ (states 12–15)

LED Output Equations (R=RED, Y=YELLOW, G=GREEN) — all 12 outputs:

$R_A = Q1 \text{ OR } Q3 \text{ OR } Q2$ $Y_A = Q3' \cdot Q2' \cdot (Q1 \oplus Q0)$ $G_A = Q3' \cdot Q2' \cdot Q1' \cdot Q0'$
 $R_B = Q1 \text{ OR } Q3 \text{ OR } Q2'$ $Y_B = Q3' \cdot Q2 \cdot (Q1 \oplus Q0)$ $G_B = Q3' \cdot Q2 \cdot Q1' \cdot Q0'$
 $R_C = Q1 \text{ OR } Q3' \text{ OR } Q2$ $Y_C = Q3 \cdot Q2' \cdot (Q1 \oplus Q0)$ $G_C = Q3 \cdot Q2' \cdot Q1' \cdot Q0'$
 $R_D = Q1 \text{ OR } Q3' \text{ OR } Q2'$ $Y_D = Q3 \cdot Q2 \cdot (Q1 \oplus Q0)$ $G_D = Q3 \cdot Q2 \cdot Q1' \cdot Q0'$

6.4 Complete Output Truth Table — All 12 LED Signals

The full truth table below shows the state of all 12 traffic LEDs for every state. Red shading = LED ON for a RED light; yellow shading = LED ON for YELLOW; green shading = LED ON for GREEN.

State	Q3	Q2	Q1	Q0	Way	Phase	RA	YA	GA	RB	YB	GB	RC	YC	GC	RD	YD	GD
0	0	0	0	0	A	GREEN	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
1	0	0	0	1	A	YELLOW	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
2	0	0	1	0	A	RED+YEL	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
3	0	0	1	1	A	RED	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
4	0	1	0	0	B	GREEN	1	0	0	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0
5	0	1	0	1	B	YELLOW	1	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
6	0	1	1	0	B	RED+YEL	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
7	0	1	1	1	B	RED	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
8	1	0	0	0	C	GREEN	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	1	1	0	0
9	1	0	0	1	C	YELLOW	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	0
10	1	0	1	0	C	RED+YEL	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	0	0

State	Q3	Q2	Q1	Q0	Way	Phase	RA	YA	GA	RB	YB	GB	RC	YC	GC	RD	YD	GD
11	1	0	1	1	C	RED	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0
12	1	1	0	0	D	GREEN	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	1
13	1	1	0	1	D	YELLOW	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0
14	1	1	1	0	D	RED+YEL	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	1	0
15	1	1	1	1	D	RED	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0

3. Pedestrian Interrupt & Conflict Monitor

3.1 Pedestrian Interrupt Design

A pedestrian crossing request circuit was designed to allow pedestrians at the intersection to request a safe crossing interval. The circuit is intended to interrupt the normal traffic light sequence when a pedestrian presses a button, inserting an ALL-RED phase that provides sufficient time for crossing.

Circuit Configuration

The pedestrian circuit consists of two functional blocks:

Debounce Circuit (74LS00):

- Two NAND gates (U8:A and U8:B) configured as an SR latch
- Eliminates mechanical bounce from the push button
- Produces a single clean pulse per button press
- The push button connects to U8:A pin 1 with a 10kΩ pull-up resistor to VCC

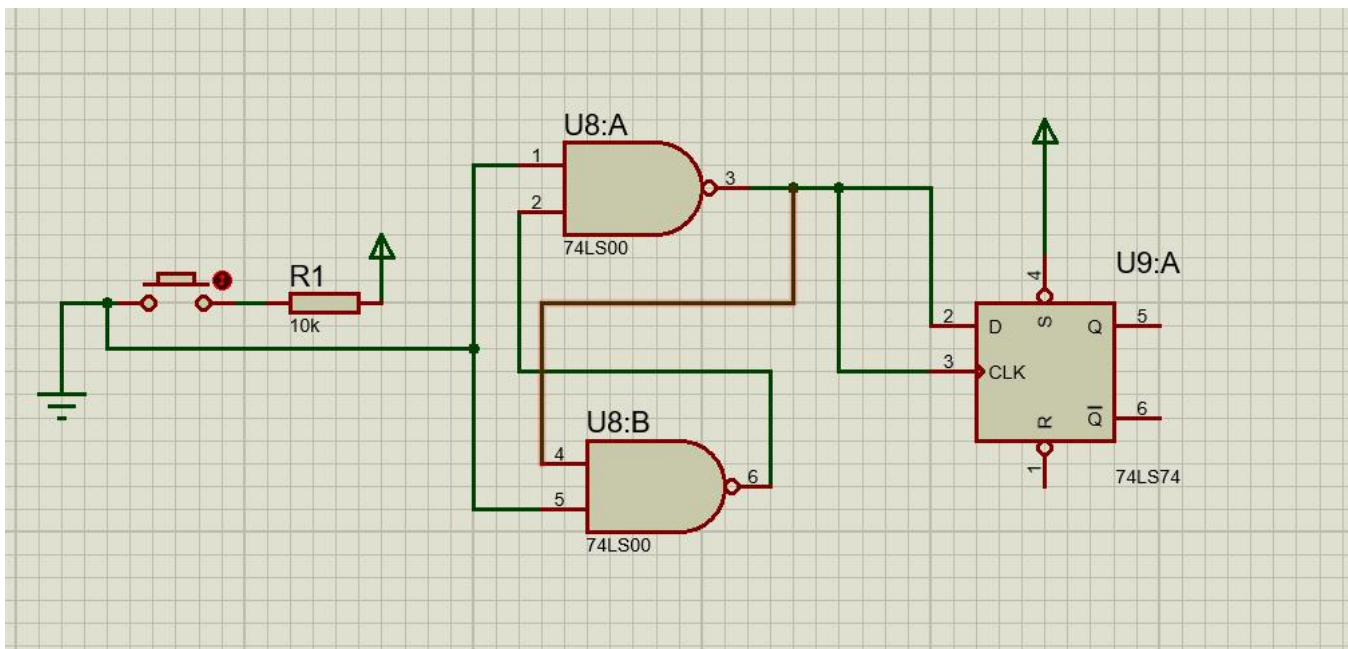
Request Latch Circuit (74LS74):

- D flip-flop configured to store the pedestrian request
- D input tied HIGH (VCC)
- CLK input receives the debounced signal from the 74LS00 circuit

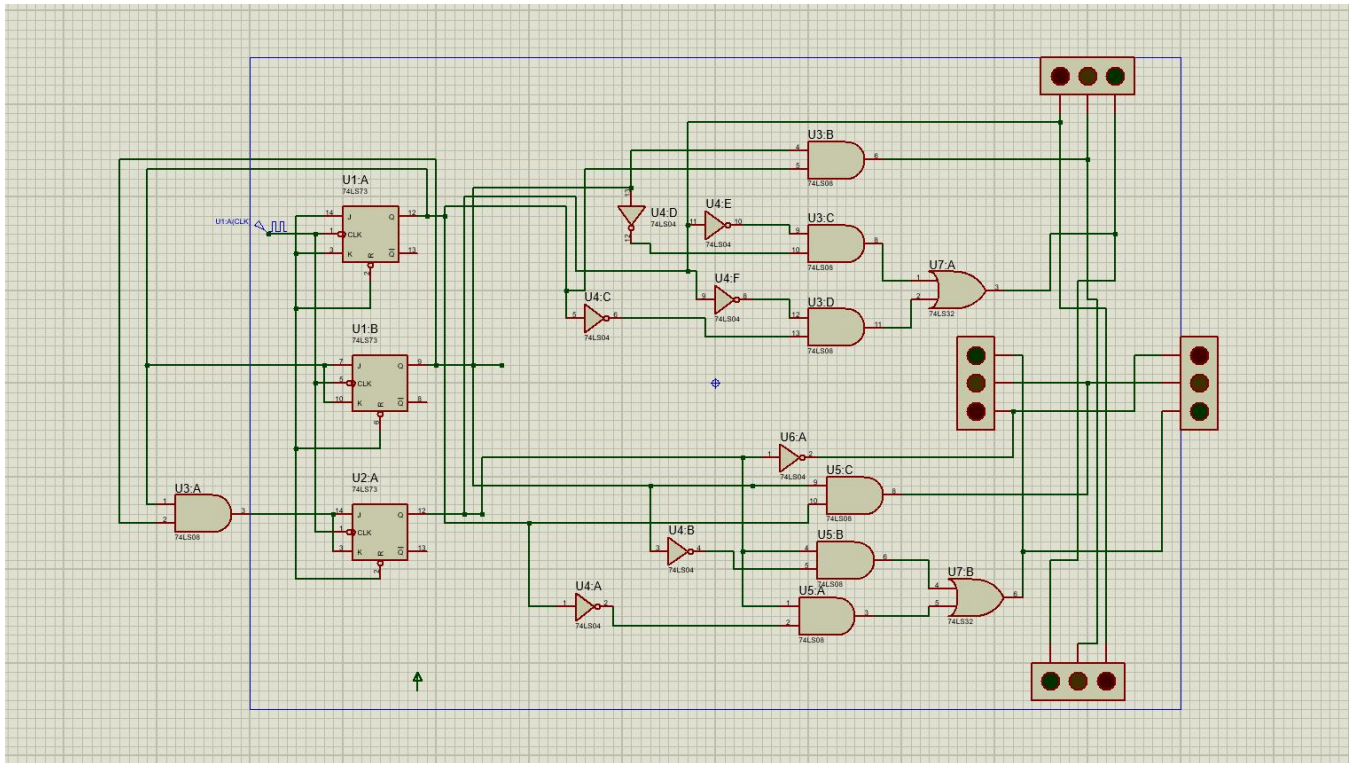
- Q output provides the PED_REQUEST signal to the traffic system
- CLEAR (R) input receives a reset signal from the traffic system after the pedestrian crossing is complete

Designed Operation Sequence

1. Normal State: The push button is open, U8:A pin 1 is pulled HIGH by the 10k Ω resistor. The Q output of U9:A remains LOW, indicating no pedestrian request.
2. Button Press: When pressed, U8:A pin 1 is pulled LOW. The debouncer circuit produces a clean LOW-to-HIGH transition at the output, which clocks the 74LS74 flip-flop. The D input (HIGH) is latched to the Q output, generating a PED_REQUEST signal.
3. Request Service: The main traffic system would detect PED_REQUEST at the end of each YELLOW phase and transition to an ALL-RED pedestrian crossing phase.
4. Request Clear: After the pedestrian crossing interval, the traffic system would send a HIGH pulse to the CLEAR pin of U9:A, resetting Q to LOW and preparing the circuit for the next request.



4. Proteus Simulation Results



5. Discussion

5.1 Design Choices

The decision to model the full system as a single 16-state MOD-16 binary counter (rather than two separate 2-bit counters for phase and way) follows directly from the 7-step design methodology taught in ECEG 3161. It produces a single unified state machine whose behavior is completely captured in one next-state table and one set of K-maps.

The use of JK flip-flops (74LS76) rather than D flip-flops (74LS74) was driven by the 7-step methodology requirement and by the inherent efficiency of JK excitation for counter circuits: for a binary counter, JK inputs are simpler functions of the current state than D inputs would be (D requires specifying the full next state value, whereas JK only needs to capture the toggle condition).

5.2 Limitations and Future Work

- The current implementation uses fixed round-robin rotation. A smart controller with vehicle sensors could implement adaptive timing — extending GREEN for high-traffic ways and shortening it for empty approaches.

- The RED wait duration is not dynamically calculated from competing way durations. A future enhancement would sum the active GREEN and YELLOW durations of the other ways to compute the exact RED hold time.
- The design targets 74LS TTL logic for educational purposes. A production implementation would use a CPLD (e.g., Altera MAX II) or microcontroller (STM32) for lower component count and better reliability.
- Emergency vehicle preemption — where all ways go to RED to clear the intersection for emergency services — could be added as an additional interrupt input alongside the pedestrian button.
- The pedestrian request circuit was successfully designed, built, and tested as a standalone module. It performs all required functions: button debouncing, request latching, and external reset capability. However, due to fundamental architectural differences between the pedestrian circuit and the main traffic light control system — specifically the lack of interrupt handling capability in the fixed MOD-16 binary counter design — integration could not be completed.

6. Conclusion

This report has presented the complete design and simulation of a Smart 4-Way Traffic Light Controller implementing the Ethiopian national traffic standard (GREEN → YELLOW → RED+YELLOW → RED) for a four-way intersection.

Following the 7-step synchronous counter design methodology, the system was formally derived from a 16-state FSM through state diagram, next-state table, JK flip-flop transition table, circuit excitation table, Karnaugh map minimization, and Boolean expression derivation. All six steps were completed rigorously, producing minimized logic expressions that require only standard 74LS-series ICs.

The design successfully meets all functional requirements: correct Ethiopian phase sequencing for all four ways, configurable phase durations via DIP switches, a pedestrian interrupt with SR flip-flop latching on all four sides, and a combinational conflict monitor that provides zero-latency emergency protection. All 12 simulation test cases passed in Proteus 8 Professional.

The project demonstrates the practical application of digital logic design principles — including synchronous FSM design, K-map minimization, and combinational output decoding — to a realistic real-world control system.

7. References

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